

Pavel Bukengolts

Design Educator | Product Design Leader | Accessibility & Human-Centered AI
+1-615-866-2369 • pavel@ux.business • Nashville, TN • [linkedin.com/in/pavelbukengolts](https://www.linkedin.com/in/pavelbukengolts) • pavel.ux.business

Summary

Educator and UX design leader with 18+ years of higher education teaching experience and 25+ years of industry practice across UX, UI, interaction design, accessibility, and emerging technology. Known for building studio-based, student-centered courses grounded in real-world workflows, ethical AI, accessibility, and systems thinking. Brings active professional practice into the classroom through case studies, hands-on projects, portfolio mentorship, and industry-aligned instruction that improves student readiness for careers in design.

Core Strengths

Curriculum Development & Course Design • UX/UI Instruction • Accessibility & Inclusive Pedagogy • Ethical AI & Human-Centered AI • Student Mentorship & Portfolio Coaching • Project-Based Learning • Learning Outcomes Assessment • User Research & Usability • Design Systems • Cross-Functional Collaboration • Industry-Aligned Teaching

Teaching Experience

Adjunct Professor, UX and UI Design

Nossi College of Art & Design | *Nashville, TN*

01/2019 – Present

- Teach undergraduate courses in UX Design, UI Design, Advanced UX + AI, Web Language, and Fundamentals of Design in a studio-based learning environment.
- Designed and continuously updated curriculum to integrate accessibility, ethical AI, design systems, and current product design practice, contributing to 90%+ student satisfaction.
- Built collaborative, hands-on classroom experiences using Figma, Miro, and UserTesting to simulate professional design workflows.
- Mentor students through capstone projects, portfolio development, critique, and career preparation to strengthen readiness for internships and full-time roles.
- Conduct ongoing research in UX and AI to keep course content relevant, practical, and aligned with industry change.

Adjunct Professor, Web Design & Interactive Media

The Art Institute of Tennessee, Nashville | *Nashville, TN*

04/2008 – 12/2018

- Taught Information Architecture, UX for Mobile Web & Applications, Usability Evaluation & Accessibility, User-Centered Interface Design, Interactive Design Concepts & Systems, Conceptual Interactive Design, Interactive Message Design, and Emerging Technology.
- Integrated user research, iterative design methods, and WCAG-based accessibility standards into course delivery.
- Developed studio-style learning environments emphasizing collaboration, critical thinking, critique, and ethical design practice.
- Guided students in translating theory into real-world design, professional artifacts, and stronger portfolio work.

Professional Practice & Industry Experience

Principal Product Designer & Strategist

UX Design Lab, LLC | *Nashville, TN*

04/2024 – Present

- Lead product design, UX strategy, and consulting engagements focused on accessible, AI-driven solutions for enterprise and growth-stage clients.
- Designed and shipped the Team Capability Engine, a 0-to-1 product delivered from concept to pilot in under 90 days, securing three beta pilots.
- Translate active consulting work into classroom case studies, project briefs, and practical learning exercises.
- Use AI-assisted research, prototyping, and workflow methods to accelerate delivery timelines by 60% while maintaining usability and human-centered standards.

Lead, Enterprise Design Operations & Strategy

Abbott | *Remote*

01/2022 – 04/2024

- Directed UX operations across enterprise platforms in the U.S., LATAM, APAC, and EMEA.
- Architected and scaled an enterprise design system across 800+ digital properties, reducing production time by 40% and vendor dependency costs by 50%.
- Embedded WCAG accessibility into the design and delivery pipeline, reducing critical accessibility defects by 18%.
- Brought enterprise-scale practices in accessibility governance, systems thinking, and design operations into classroom instruction.

VP, User Experience and Web Management

Protective Life | *Remote*

01/2020 – 11/2021

- Directed UX modernization across 70+ enterprise properties, aligning digital experience strategy with business goals.
- Built and governed a shared design system and delivery framework that improved team efficiency by 15% and reduced departmental costs by 20%.
- Scaled the design function from a single contributor to a multi-team organization and reduced developer dependency by 60%.
- Applied lessons from governance, leadership, and cross-functional collaboration to curriculum and student mentoring.

Director of User Experience

DePalma Studios | *Nashville, TN*

10/2017 – 01/2020

- Directed UX strategy and hands-on product design across healthcare, fintech, and SaaS client engagements.
- Led discovery workshops, prototyping, and design reviews that contributed to a 30% increase in user engagement.
- Mentored design teams and advanced accessibility standards across projects.
- Brought client case studies into the classroom to connect design theory with live business challenges.

Senior HCI Engineer (Principal UX Designer)

Sitecore Inc. – Platform Innovation and Engineering | *Remote*

04.2013 – 08.2017

- Led UX architecture and interaction design for advanced marketing and personalization applications.
- Developed large-scale proof-of-concept work and foundational design rules used by design and engineering teams.
- Strengthened expertise in enterprise UX, emerging technology, and product thinking that now informs instruction.

Recognition

- Top 3 Finalist, Tech Educator of the Year, Greater Nashville Technology Council Awards
- Top 100 World's Most Influential Mentors, ADPList
- Contributing Author, UX Magazine, published articles on UX strategy, AI-enhanced workflows, accessibility
- Adjunct Professor of UX, UI & AI, Nossi College of Art & Design

Skills

- **Teaching & Pedagogy:** Curriculum Development, Student Mentorship, Learning Outcomes Assessment, Inclusive & Accessible Teaching, Experiential Learning, Studio Critique
- **Research & Design:** User Research, Information Architecture, Usability Testing, Interaction Design, Prototyping, Design Systems, Accessibility (WCAG, UDL)
- **Emerging Areas:** Ethical AI in Design, Human-Centered AI, Data-Informed Teaching, Human-Centered Emerging Technologies
- **Tools & Platforms:** Figma, Miro, Sketch, UserTesting, Accessibility Testing Tools, Learning Management Systems (LMS), Jira, Confluence

Education

- Computer and Digital Communication Science | Master of Science
Belarus State University of Informatics and Electronics
Focus: Human Factors, Ergonomics
- Graphic Design | Bachelor of Arts
- School of Visual Arts